The Fourth Sheet

Example report · Not-for-profits

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

What does it cost to raise a dollar?

Period: January 2026. What fundraising costs (grant writing, donor campaigns, events) for every dollar it brings in. Pick a source and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

January 2026 Locked January 2026 is locked (closed 3 Feb 2026). These numbers won't change.

In short: Each dollar raised cost 13¢ in January, and 14¢ a dollar this financial year to date.

Source: All fundraising

January · all fundraising
13¢
December 14¢

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
14¢
same period last year: not in the data

Cost to raise a dollar, by source, January 2026 (cents)



What it shows
January cost 13¢ to raise each dollar, against 14¢ in December. This financial year to date it has cost 14¢ a dollar.

What you'd do about it
The year-to-date figure is steadier than single months: events make some months jump. Pick a source above to see which one moves it.

Source: Grants

January · Grants
12¢
December 10¢

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
11¢
same period last year: not in the data

What it shows
Grants cost 11¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($49,700 of grant writing and reporting for $450,671).

What you'd do about it
Usually the cheapest money to raise, as long as the time that goes into applications and acquittals is protected.

Source: Donations

January · Donations
17¢
December 17¢

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
15¢
same period last year: not in the data

What it shows
Donations cost 15¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($18,500 of donor campaigns for $119,700).

What you'd do about it
Steady and cheap, and untied: the money that builds reserves.

Source: Fundraising events

January · Fundraising events

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December 42¢

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)

41¢

same period last year: not in the data

What it shows

Fundraising events cost 41¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($17,800 of event costs for $43,000).

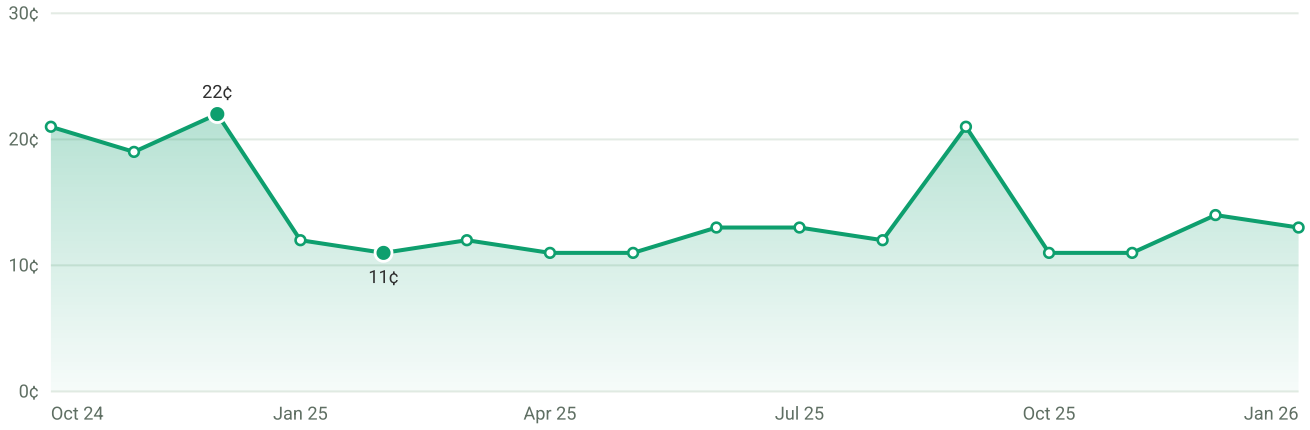
What you'd do about it

Usually the dearest money to raise: events are worth counting for what else they bring too (new donors, profile).

Every source at once

Cost to raise a dollar, by month (cents)

All · Cents per $1



Months with an event (the gala, the Christmas appeal) jump. A gap means nothing was raised that month. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.